

► 1941 PACK

Date 1941

Origin US

Material Nylon, cotton

This small pack was used to hold rations and personal effects, while the rolled sheet of camouflage canvas formed half of a "pup" tent when joined to a second sheet.

Mitchell-pattern camouflage issued only to Marine Corps



MAP OF SAIGON BASE AREA

PARACHUTE FLARE

ANGLE HEAD FLASHLIGHT

◄ M1955 ARMoured VEST

Date 1960s

Origin US

Material Fibreglass, plastic, nylon

The Doron-armoured (fibreglass and plastic) vest – heavy and unsuitable for tropical conditions – would have little chance of stopping a bullet, but it was an effective defence against shrapnel.

M1943 folding entrenching shovel

▼ M14 RIFLE

Date 1959

Origin US

Weight 4.4kg (9½lb)

Barrel 55.8cm (22in)

Calibre 7.62mm

Designed to use the then-standard NATO round, the US M14 replaced the old M1 rifle. The M14 possessed a fully automatic fire capability and was equipped with a larger magazine. By the late 1960s, it was replaced by the M16.



Rear sight

20-round detachable magazine

Flash hider

Safety pin ring

▼ M79 GRENADE LAUNCHER

Date 1961

Origin US

Weight 2.75kg (6lb)

Barrel 30.5cm (12in)

Calibre 40mm

Range 300m (985ft)

With a maximum range of 300m (985ft), the M79 grenade launcher bridged the gap between the hand grenade and the mortar. As well as firing high explosive, the M79 could fire antipersonnel, smoke, and illuminating rounds. Two were issued to each rifle squad.

Fold-down leaf sight, graduated to 350m (1,150ft)

◄ M67 GRENADES

Date 1960s

Origin US

Weight 0.45kg (1lb)

Length 89mm (3½in)

The M67 "baseball" grenade had a notched-wire interior designed to fragment into many small pieces on the detonation of its high-explosive charge.

▼ M60 MACHINE-GUN

Date 1963

Origin US

Weight 10.51kg (23lb)

Barrel 59.9cm (23½in)

Calibre 7.62mm

The M60 was the US example of the general-purpose machine-gun – inheriting some design features from the German MG42. It was widely used by the US Marine Corps in Vietnam and is still in service today.



Rubber pad absorbs recoil

Carrying handle

Feed cover

Heat shield

Fore sight

Pistol grip

Bipod (folded)

